



Combining Machine-Learning and Dynamic Network Models for Sepsis Prediction

Juri Backes^{1,3}, Artyom Tsanda^{1,2}, Tobias Knopp^{1,2}, Wolfgang Renz³, and Eckehard Schöll⁴

¹TU Hamburg, ²UKE Hamburg, ³HAW Hamburg, ⁴TU Berlin

2026-03-11

Sepsis and the Dynamic Network Model

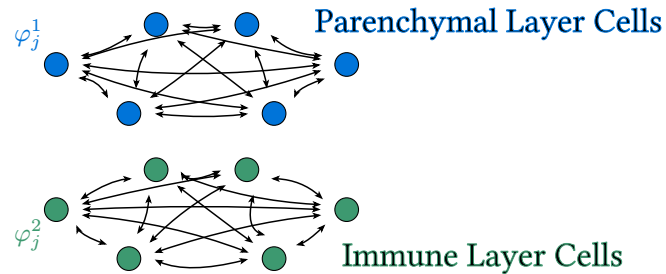
Functional modeling (adaptive cell communication)

- Interaction of parenchymal (organ) and immune cells via cytokines

Two-layer dynamic network model

- Adaptive phase oscillators

Dynamic Network Model (DNM)



$$\dot{\varphi}_i^1 = -\frac{1}{N} \sum_{j=1}^N \left\{ (1 + \kappa_{ij}^1) \sin(\varphi_i^1 - \varphi_j^1 - 0.28\pi) \right\} - \sigma \sin(\varphi_i^1 - \varphi_i^2)$$

$$\dot{\kappa}_{ij}^1 = -0.03(\kappa_{ij}^1 + \sin(\varphi_i^1 - \varphi_j^1 - \beta))$$

$$\dot{\varphi}_i^2 = -\frac{1}{N} \sum_{j=1}^N \left\{ \kappa_{ij}^2 \sin(\varphi_i^2 - \varphi_j^2 - 0.28\pi) \right\} - \sigma \sin(\varphi_i^2 - \varphi_i^1)$$

$$\dot{\kappa}_{ij}^2 = -0.3(\kappa_{ij}^2 + \sin(\varphi_i^2 - \varphi_j^2 - \beta))$$

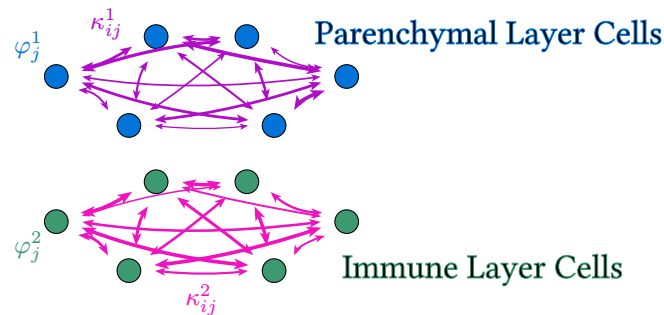
Functional modeling (adaptive cell communication)

- Interaction of parenchymal (organ) and immune cells via cytokines

Two-layer dynamic network model

- Adaptive phase oscillators

Dynamic Network Model (DNM)



$$\dot{\varphi}_i^1 = -\frac{1}{N} \sum_{j=1}^N \left\{ (1 + \kappa_{ij}^1) \sin(\varphi_i^1 - \varphi_j^1 - 0.28\pi) \right\} - \sigma \sin(\varphi_i^1 - \varphi_i^2)$$

$$\dot{\kappa}_{ij}^1 = -0.03(\kappa_{ij}^1 + \sin(\varphi_i^1 - \varphi_j^1 - \beta))$$

$$\dot{\varphi}_i^2 = -\frac{1}{N} \sum_{j=1}^N \left\{ \kappa_{ij}^2 \sin(\varphi_i^2 - \varphi_j^2 - 0.28\pi) \right\} - \sigma \sin(\varphi_i^2 - \varphi_i^1)$$

$$\dot{\kappa}_{ij}^2 = -0.3(\kappa_{ij}^2 + \sin(\varphi_i^2 - \varphi_j^2 - \beta))$$

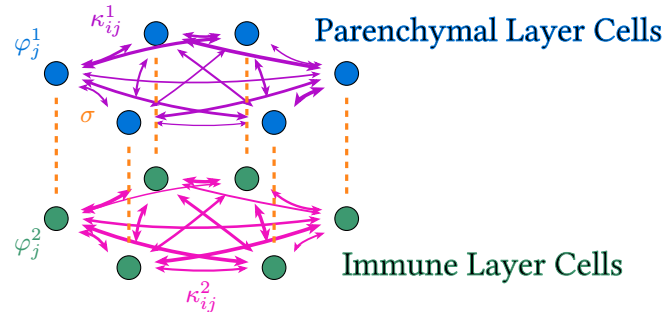
Functional modeling (adaptive cell communication)

- Interaction of parenchymal (organ) and immune cells via cytokines

Two-layer dynamic network model

- Adaptive phase oscillators

Dynamic Network Model (DNM)



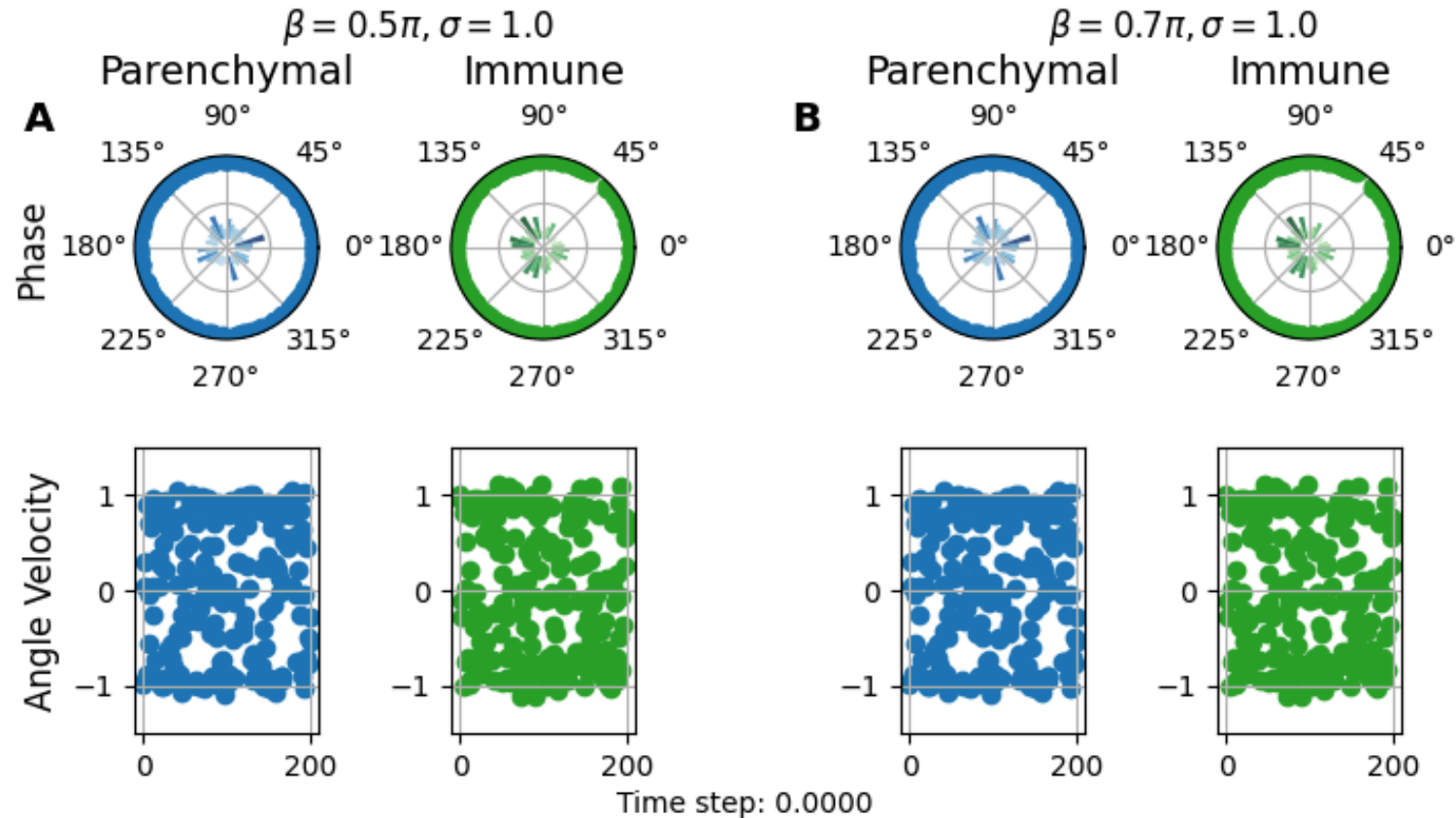
$$\dot{\varphi}_i^1 = -\frac{1}{N} \sum_{j=1}^N \left\{ (1 + \kappa_{ij}^1) \sin(\varphi_i^1 - \varphi_j^1 - 0.28\pi) \right\} - \sigma \sin(\varphi_i^1 - \varphi_i^2)$$

$$\dot{\kappa}_{ij}^1 = -0.03(\kappa_{ij}^1 + \sin(\varphi_i^1 - \varphi_j^1 - \beta))$$

$$\dot{\varphi}_i^2 = -\frac{1}{N} \sum_{j=1}^N \left\{ \kappa_{ij}^2 \sin(\varphi_i^2 - \varphi_j^2 - 0.28\pi) \right\} - \sigma \sin(\varphi_i^2 - \varphi_i^1)$$

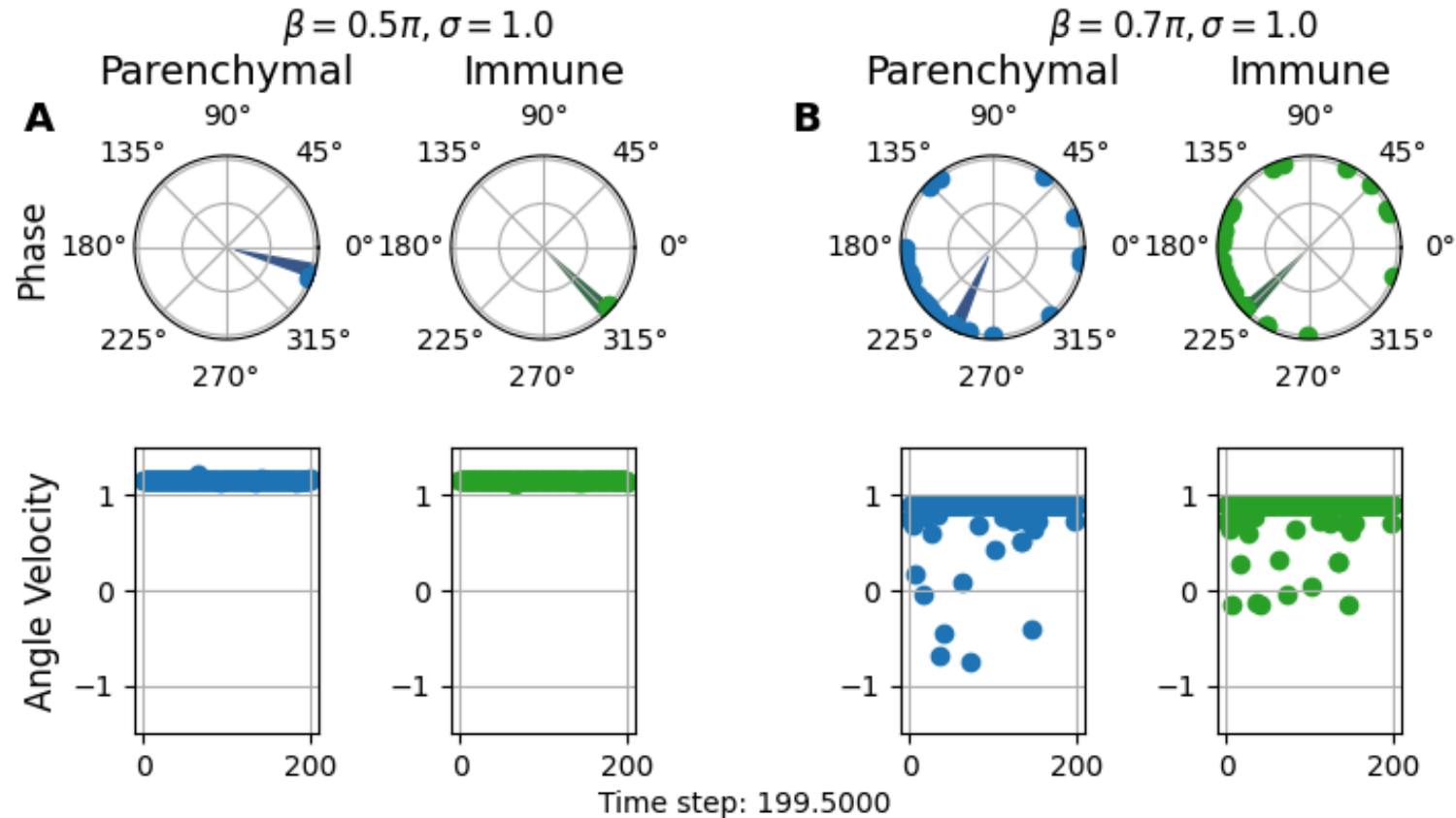
$$\dot{\kappa}_{ij}^2 = -0.3(\kappa_{ij}^2 + \sin(\varphi_i^2 - \varphi_j^2 - \beta))$$

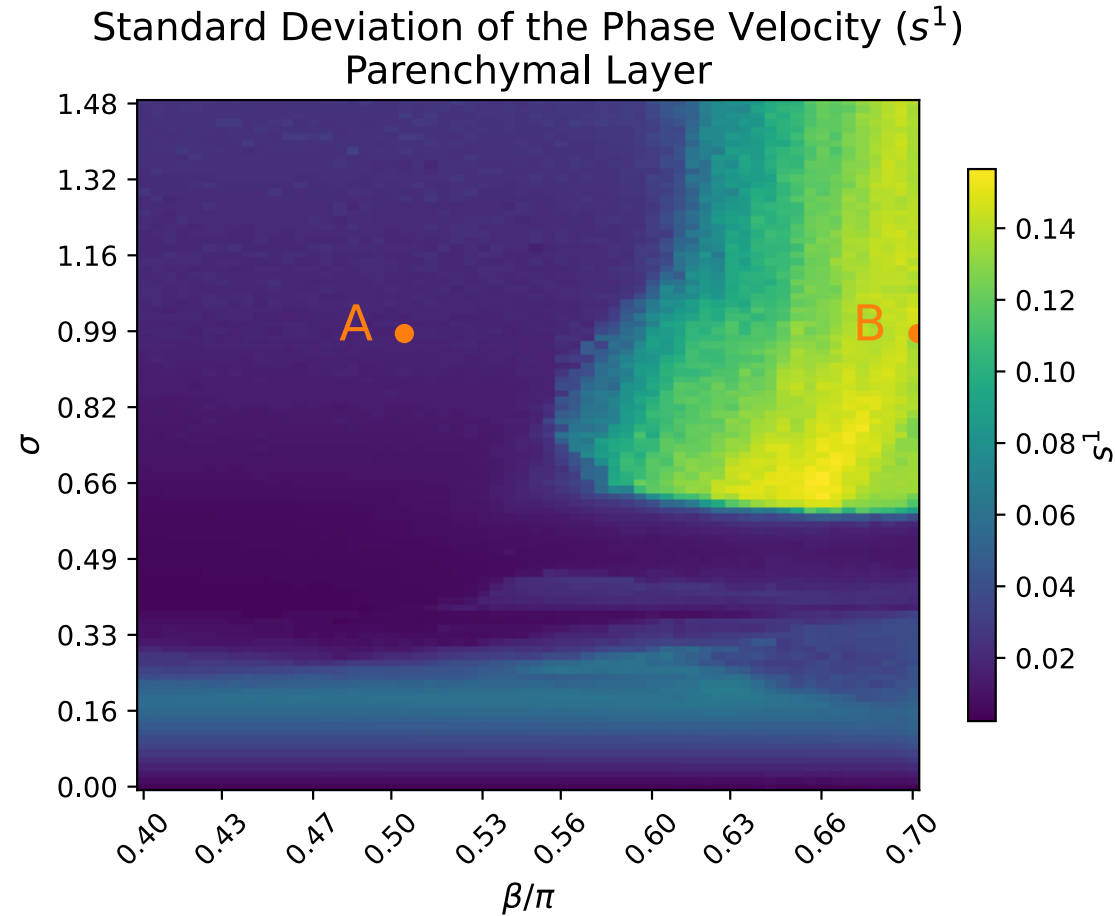
Sepsis and the Dynamic Network Model



Simulation Video

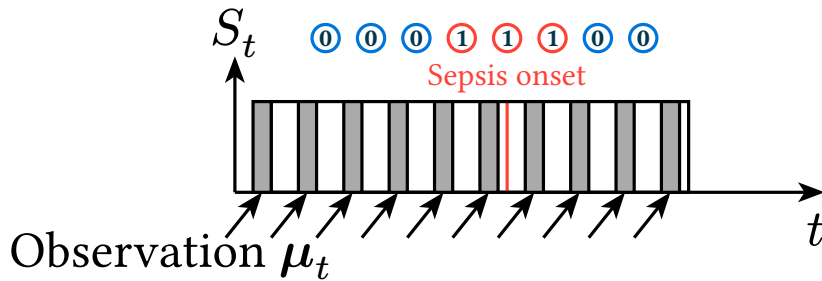
Sepsis and the Dynamic Network Model





Latent Dynamics Model

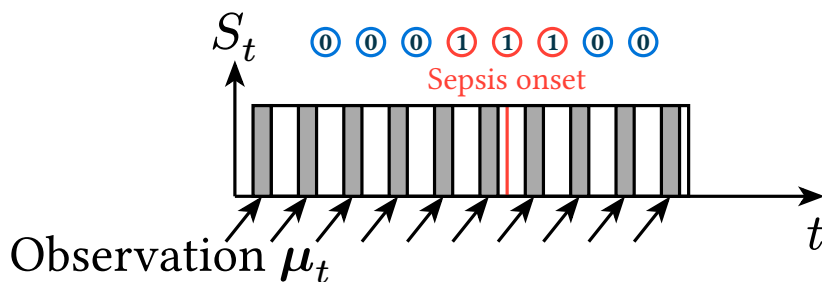
Online Prediction



Sepsis Definition (simplified) $\rightarrow S_t$

1. Infection $\rightarrow I_t$
2. Rapid Organ Failure $\rightarrow A_t$
 - SOFA-score increase ≥ 2

Online Prediction



$$\mu_t$$

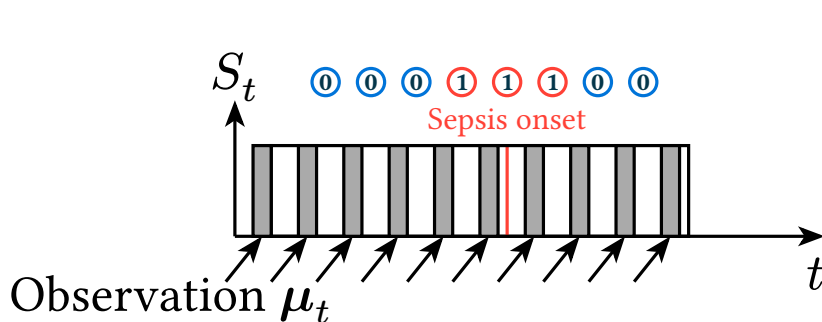
Sepsis Definition (simplified) $\rightarrow S_t$

1. Infection $\rightarrow I_t$
2. Rapid Organ Failure $\rightarrow A_t$
 - SOFA-score increase ≥ 2

Sepsis Risk

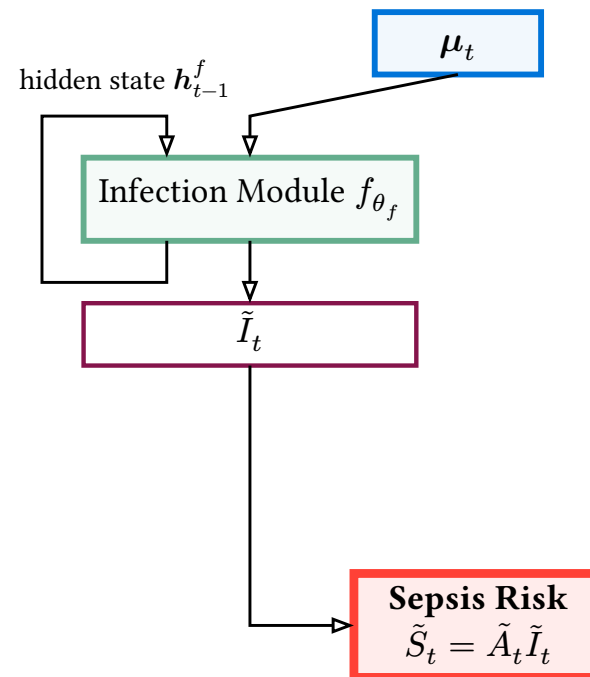
$$\tilde{S}_t = \tilde{A}_t \tilde{I}_t$$

Online Prediction

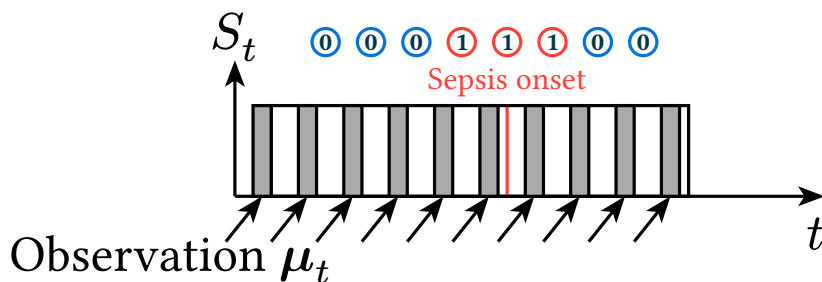


Sepsis Definition (simplified) $\rightarrow S_t$

1. Infection $\rightarrow I_t$
2. Rapid Organ Failure $\rightarrow A_t$
 - SOFA-score increase ≥ 2

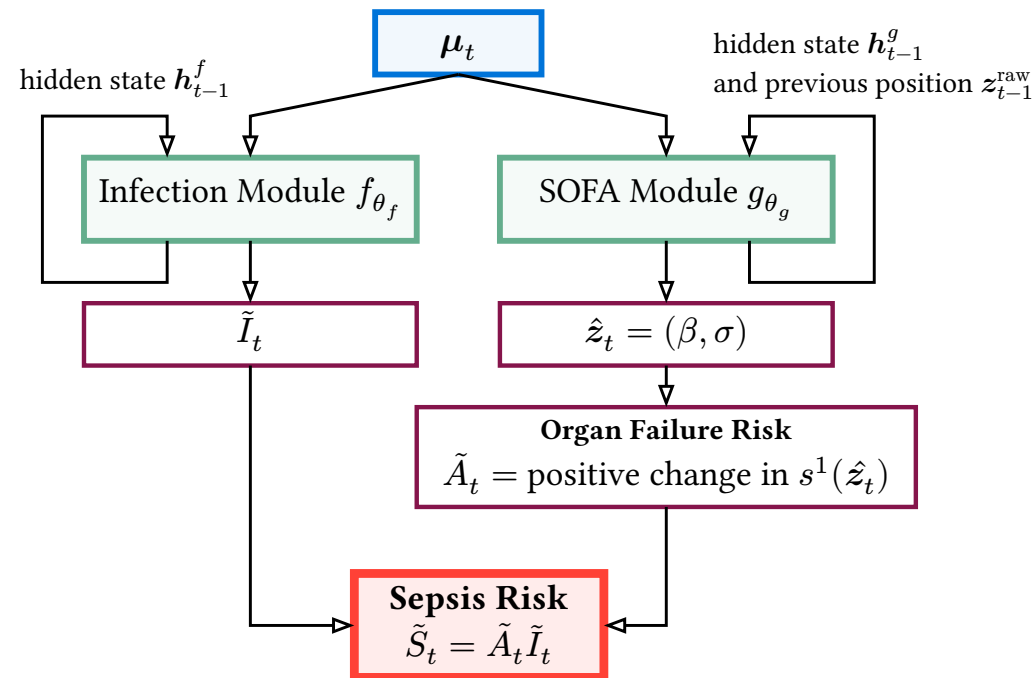


Online Prediction

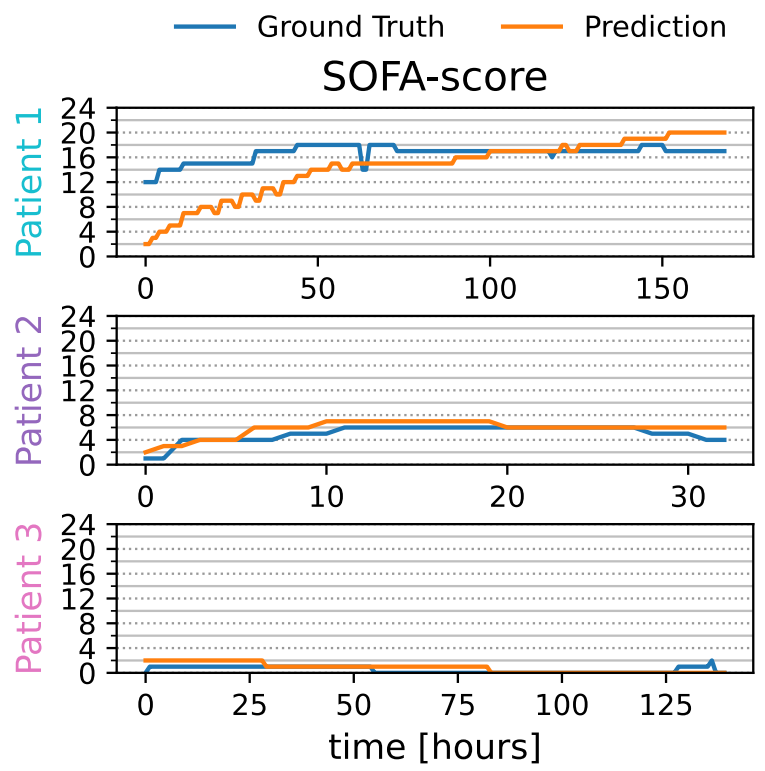
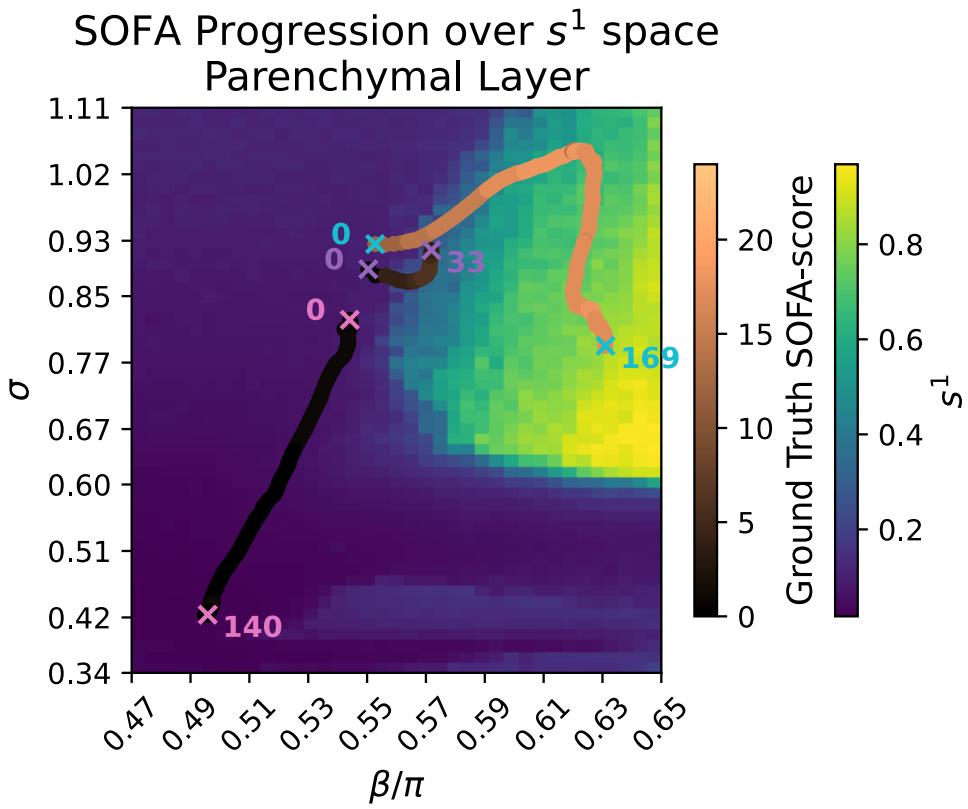


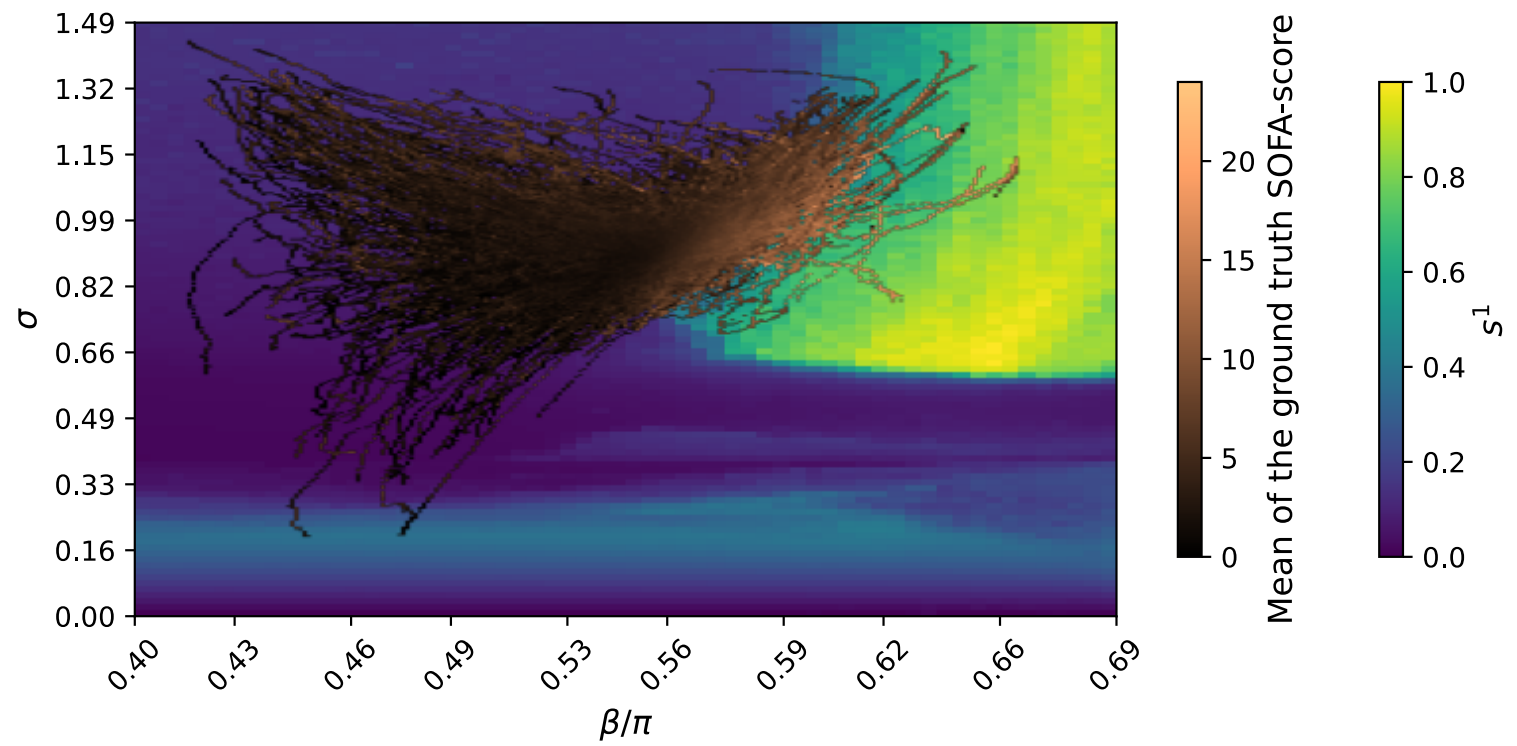
Sepsis Definition (simplified) $\rightarrow S_t$

1. Infection $\rightarrow I_t$
2. Rapid Organ Failure $\rightarrow A_t$
 - SOFA-score increase ≥ 2



Experimental Results





Comparison against mean performance of YAIB [1],
 $\text{AUROC} \times 100$ ($\uparrow$, higher is better) and $\text{AUPRC} \times 100$ ($\uparrow$).

Model	AUROC	AUPRC
YAIB		
Regularized Logistic Regression	$77.1 \pm (0.4)$	$4.6 \pm (0.1)$
Light Gradient Boosting Machine	$77.5 \pm (0.3)$	$5.9 \pm (0.2)$
Transformer	$80.0 \pm (0.8)$	$6.6 \pm (0.2)$
LSTM	$82.0 \pm (0.3)$	$8.0 \pm (0.2)$
Temporal Convolutional Network	$82.7 \pm (0.3)$	$8.8 \pm (0.2)$
GRU	$83.6 \pm (0.3)$	$9.1 \pm (0.3)$
This work		
Latent Dynamics Model	$84.01 \pm (0.8)$	$9.97 \pm (0.8)$

Conclusion

- Interpretable
 - Decomposition Strategy
 - Competitive Performance
-
- Do other sepsis models exist, that work even better?

https://github.com/unartig/sepsis_osc



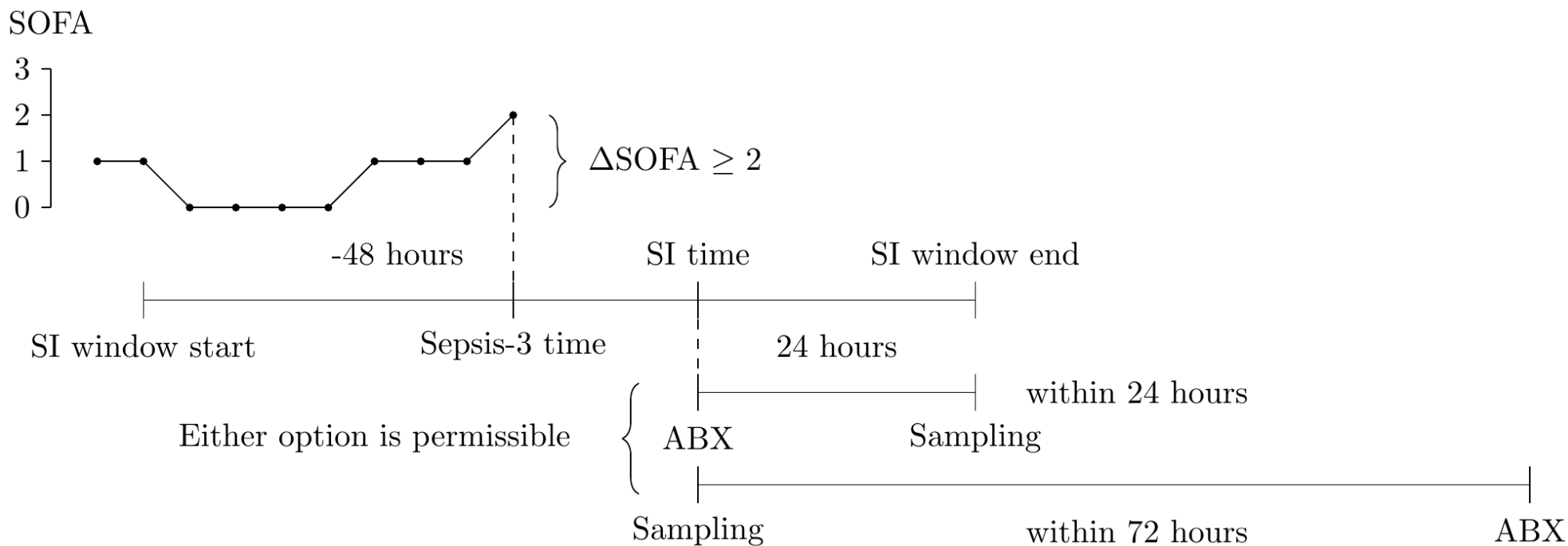


Bibliography

- [1] R. van de Water, H. N. A. Schmidt, P. Elbers, P. Thorat, B. Arnrich, and P. Rockenschaub, “Yet Another ICU Benchmark: A Flexible Multi-Center Framework for Clinical ML,” in *The Twelfth International Conference on Learning Representations*, Oct. 2024.
- [2] N. Bennett, D. Plečko, and I.-F. Ukor, “Sepsis 3 label — sep3.” [Online]. Available: https://eth-mds.github.io/ricu/reference/label_sep3.html

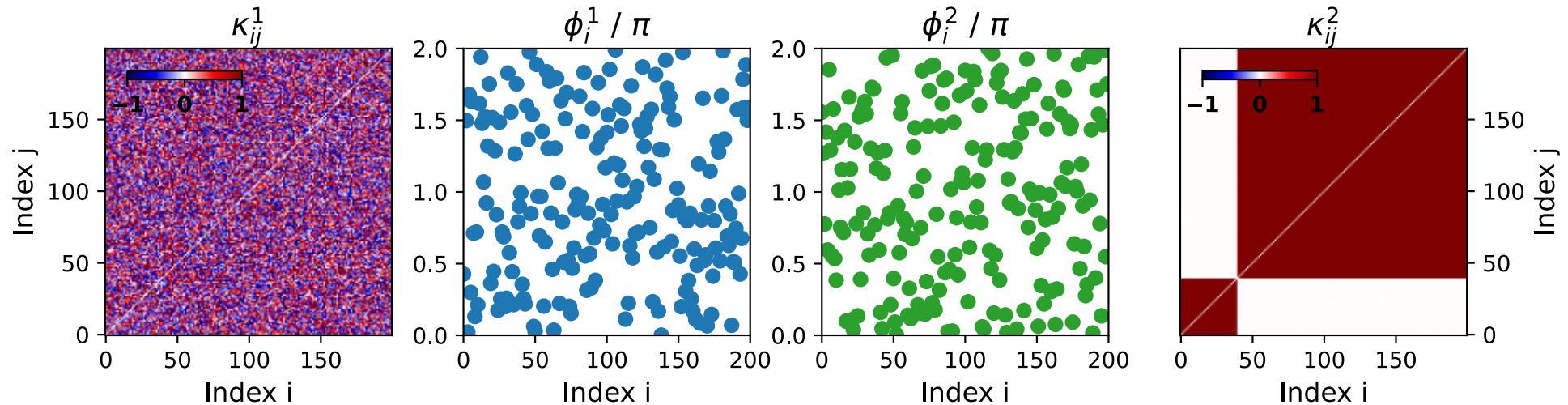
Supplemental Material

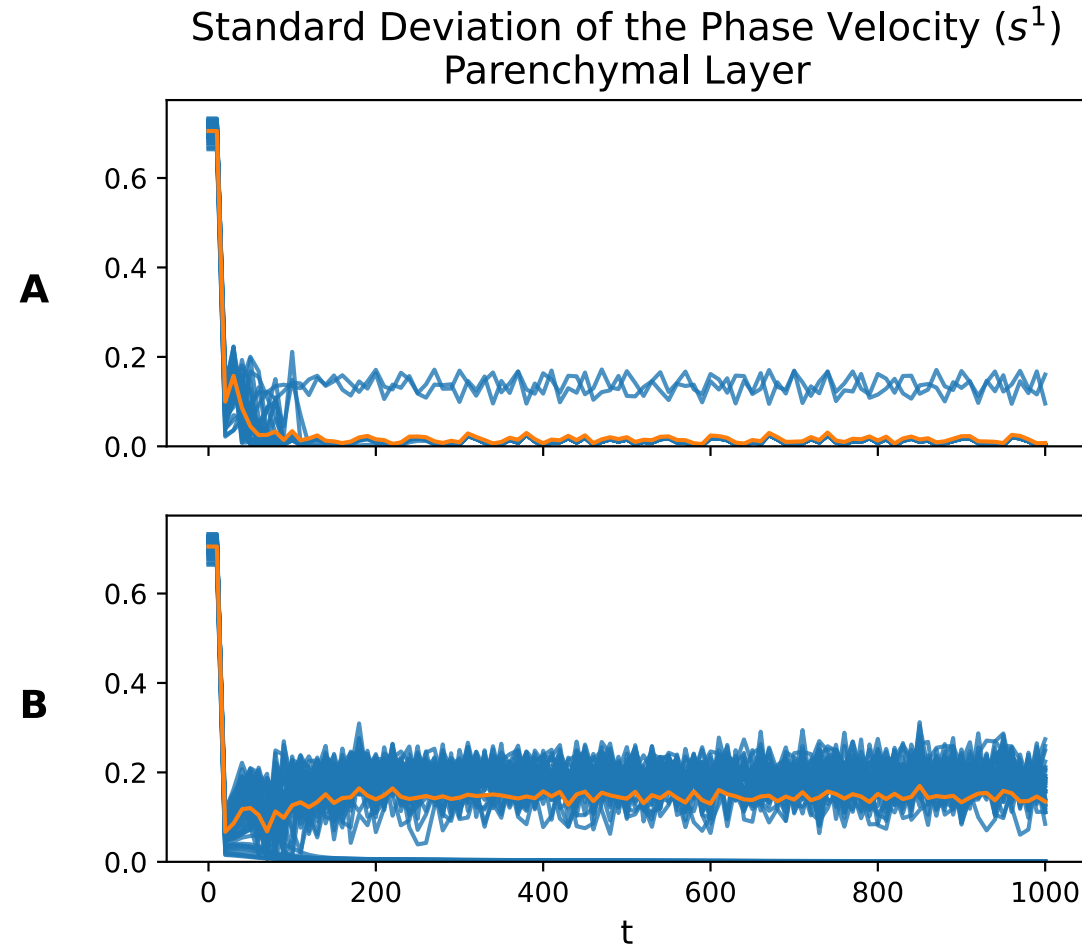
Graphical representation of the timings in the Sepsis-3 definition, taken from [2].

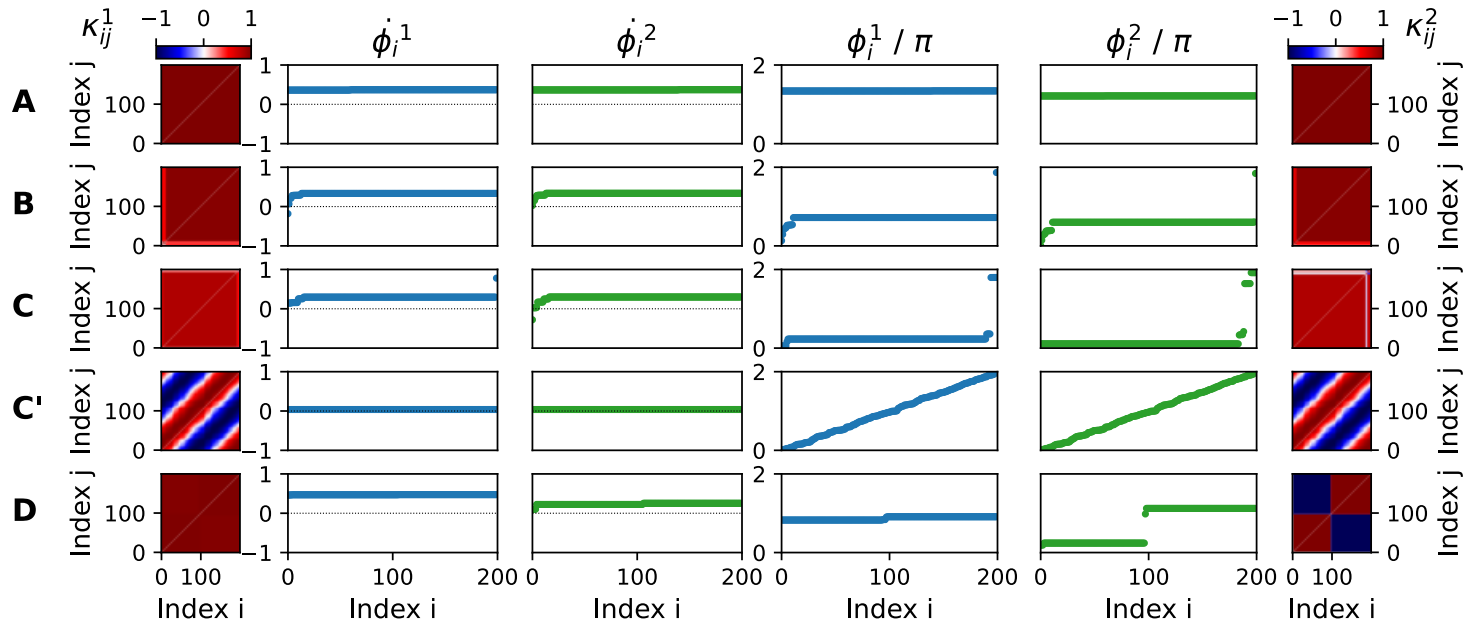


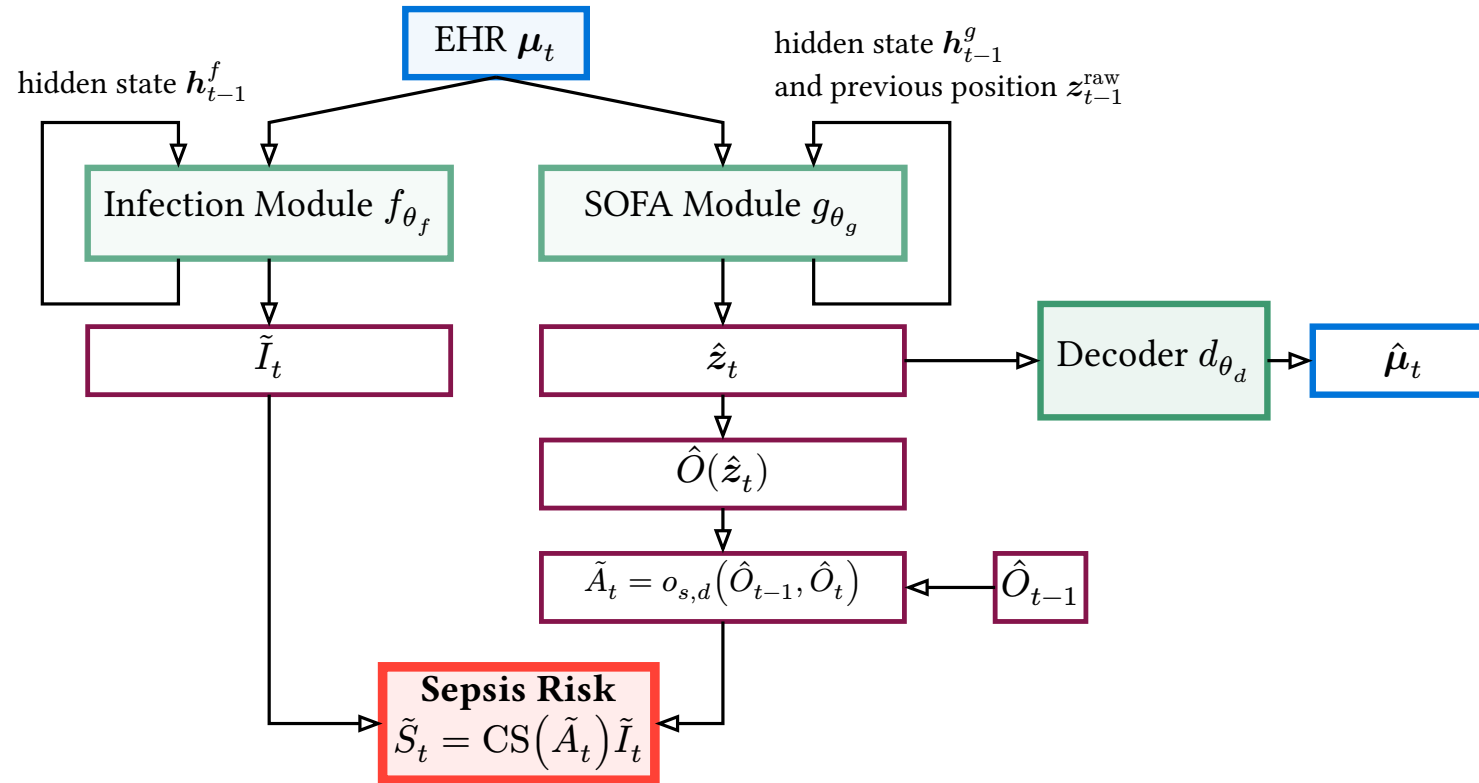
Initialization

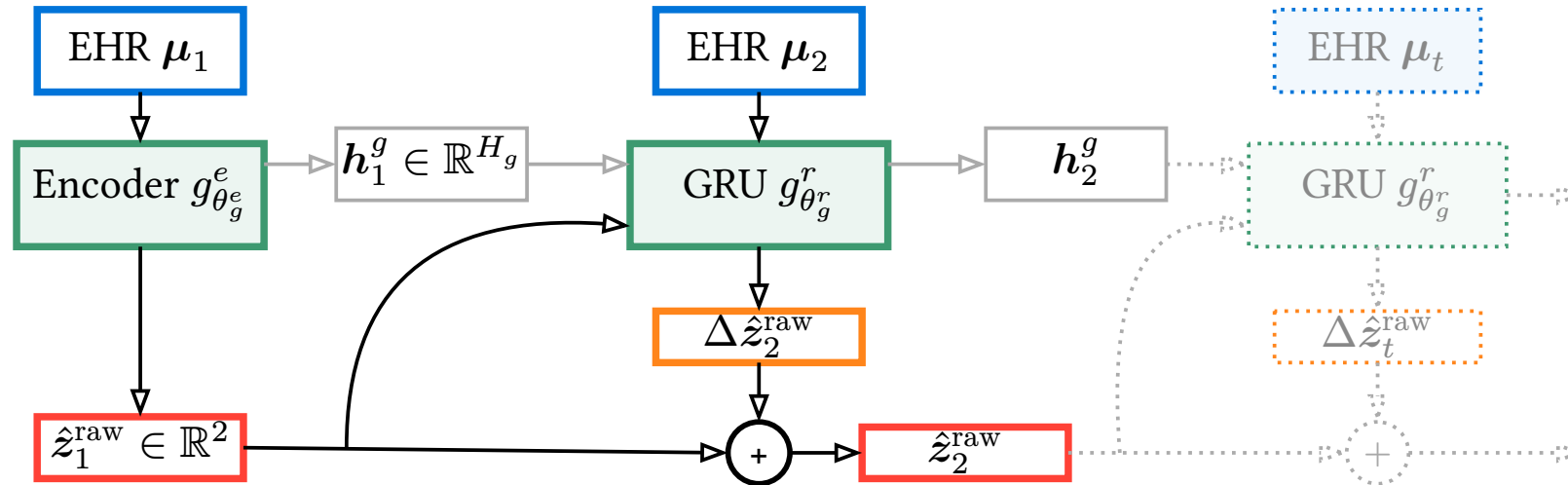
- Uniform cytokine activity in the organ layer
- Uniform initial phases
- Cytokine activation clusters in the immune layer

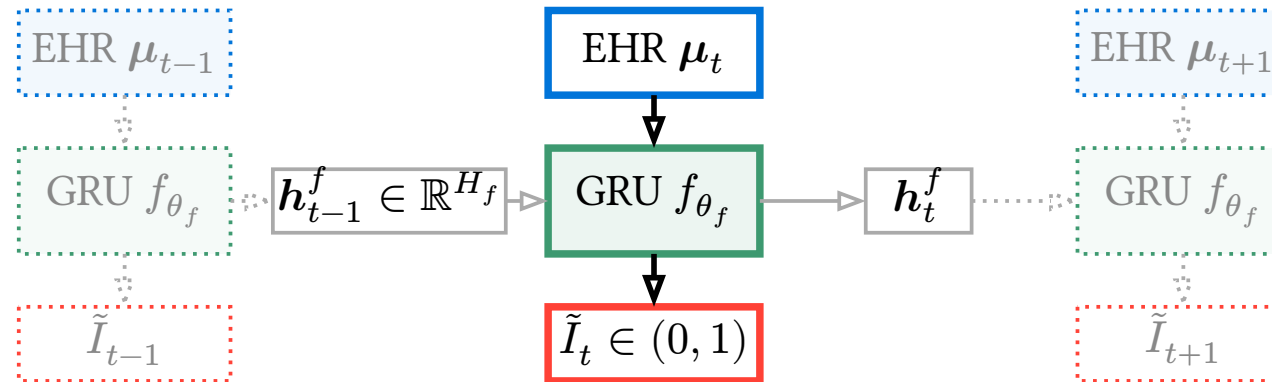




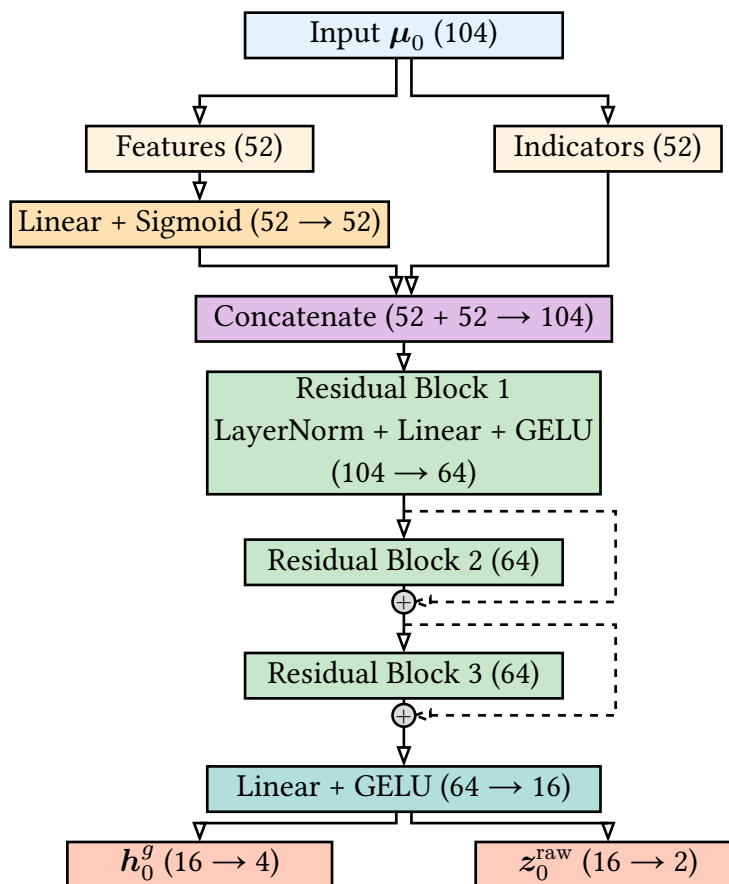




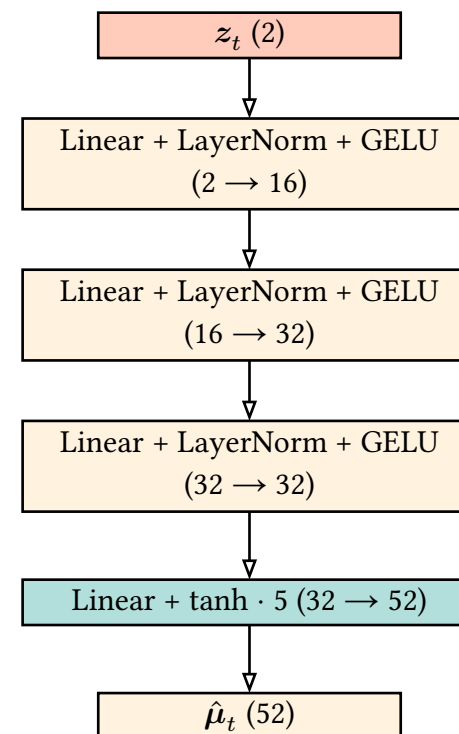


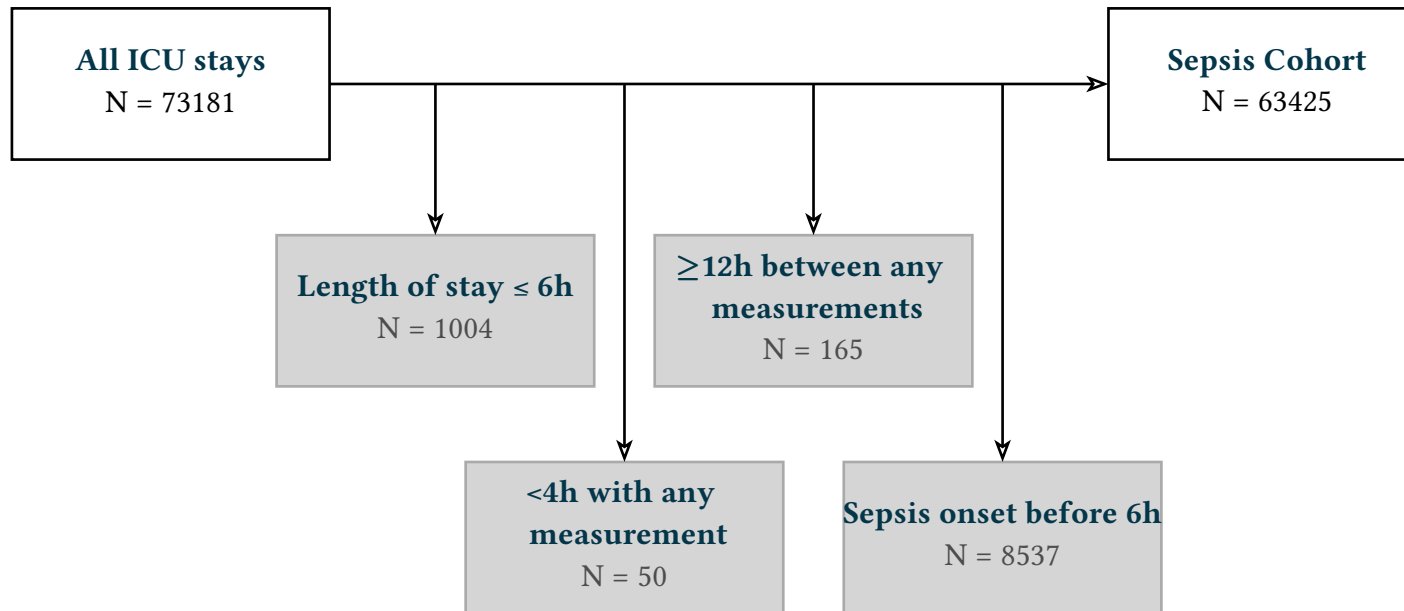


A



B





Characteristic	All patients	SEP-3 positive	SEP-3 negative
Demographics			
N	63425 (100.0)	3320 (5.2)	60105 (94.8)
Male	35170 (55.5)	1881 (56.7)	33289 (55.4)
Age at admission	65.0 (53.0–76.0)	65.0 (54.0–76.0)	65.0 (53.0–76.0)
Weight at admission	77.6 (65.1–92.3)	77.6 (65.6–94.0)	77.6 (65.0–92.2)

Characteristic	All patients	SEP-3 positive	SEP-3 negative
Clinical Outcomes			
SOFA median	3.0 (1.0–5.0)	3.0 (1.0–5.0)	3.0 (1.0–5.0)
SOFA max	4.0 (2.0–6.0)	5.0 (4.0–8.0)	4.0 (2.0–6.0)
Hospital LOS hours	157.7 (92.8–268.9)	335.1 (194.2–548.6)	150.3 (90.9–256.0)
Hospital Mortality	4828 (7.6)	879 (26.5)	3949 (6.6)
Sepsis-3 onset time	-	13.0 (8.0–34.0)	-

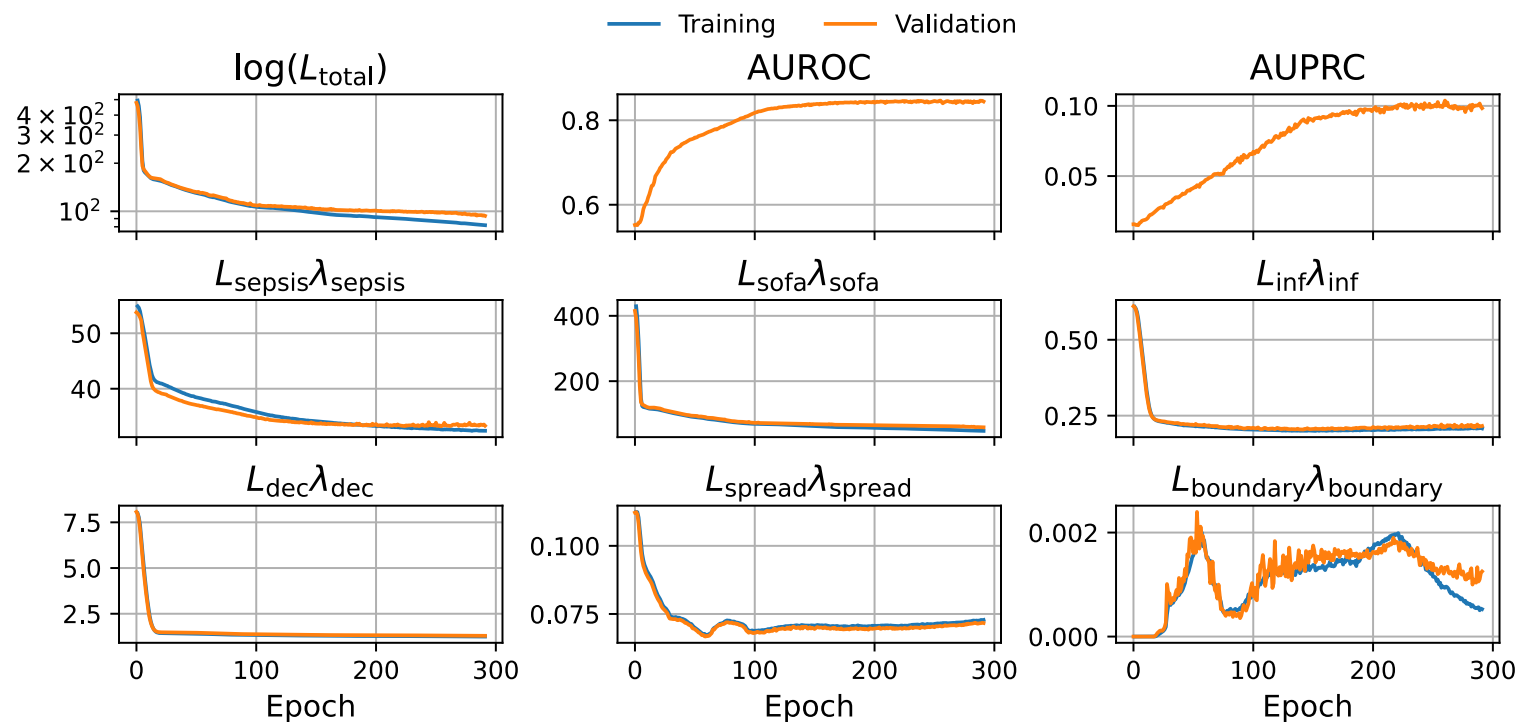
Characteristic	All patients	SEP-3 positive	SEP-3 negative
Ethnicity			
White	40364 (63.6)	2087 (62.9)	38277 (63.7)
Black	5809 (9.2)	262 (7.9)	5547 (9.2)
Asian	721 (1.1)	42 (1.3)	679 (1.1)
Hispanic	630 (1.0)	32 (1.0)	598 (1.0)
Other/Unknown	14924 (23.5)	897 (27.0)	14027 (23.3)

Characteristic	All patients	SEP-3 positive	SEP-3 negative
Admission Type			
Medical	45009 (71.0)	2817 (84.8)	42192 (70.2)
Surgical	2239 (3.5)	45 (1.4)	2194 (3.7)
Other/Unknown	15200 (24.0)	458 (13.8)	14742 (24.5)

Overview of loss components in the LDM training objective.

Loss	Type	Purpose	Supervises
$\mathcal{L}_{\text{sepsis}}$	BCE	Primary sepsis prediction	$f_{\theta_f}, g_{\theta_g^e}, g_{\theta_g^r}$
$\mathcal{L}_{\text{sofa}}$	Weighted MSE	SOFA estimation	$g_{\theta_g^e}, g_{\theta_g^r}$
$\mathcal{L}_{\text{inf}}$	BCE	Infection indicator	f_{θ_f}
$\mathcal{L}_{\text{spread}}$	Covariance	Latent diversity	$g_{\theta_g^e}, g_{\theta_g^r}$
$\mathcal{L}_{\text{boundary}}$	Positional	Latent Space	$g_{\theta_g^e}, g_{\theta_g^r}$
$\mathcal{L}_{\text{dec}}$	MSE	Latent semantics	$d_{\theta_d}, (g_{\theta_g^e}, g_{\theta_g^r})$

Progression of training and validation losses



$$\delta(\tilde{S}_t) = \mathbb{I}(\tilde{S}_t > \tau)$$

$$\text{TPR} = \frac{\text{TP}}{\text{TP} + \text{FN}}$$

$$\text{FPR} = \frac{\text{FP}}{\text{TP} + \text{FN}}$$

$$P = \frac{\text{TP}}{\text{TP} + \text{FP}}$$

$$R = \frac{\text{TP}}{\text{TP} + \text{FN}}$$

Receiver Operating Characteristic and Precision-Recall Curve.

